sion placed no limitations on what TURN or appellant could say in the envelope, except that TURN is required to state that its messages are not those of appellant. *Id.*, at A–17 to A–18. The Commission reserved the right to grant other groups access to the envelopes in the future.[5] *Ibid.*

Appellant appealed the Commission's order to the California Supreme Court, arguing that it has a First Amendment right not to help spread a message with which it disagrees, see *Wooley* v. *Maynard*, 430 U. S. 705 (1977), and that the Commission's order infringes that right. The California Supreme Court denied discretionary review. We noted probable jurisdiction, 470 U. S. 1083 (1985), and now reverse.

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and 'economic advertising value.' Some utility corporations place bumperstrip messages on their vehicles. Buses and trucks regularly carry advertising messages. In the words of the majority at page 23 of the decision, 'It is reasonable to assume that the ratepayers will benefit from exposure to a variety of views. . . .' Is it the postulate of this Commission, flowing from the decision's stated premise . . . that ratepayers would benefit from exposure to some particular socially desirable message from some ratepayer group making use of any or all such areas of excess valuable space?" *Id.*, at A–40.

Commissioner Bagley also argued that the Commission's decision would require the Commission to make forbidden content-based distinctions in order to allocate the extra space among competing speakers. *Id.*, at A–41. Commissioner Calvo contended, first, that the order infringed appellant's First Amendment rights, and, second, that it was unnecessary because "TURN has other opportunities to reach its natural audience." *Id.*, at A–56. Commissioner Calvo noted that the Commission often awarded TURN and similar groups fees for their participation in ratemaking proceedings, funds that presumably could finance separate mailings. *Ibid.*

[5] The Commission has already *denied* access to at least one group based on the content of its speech. The Commission denied the application of a taxpayer group—the Committee of More than One Million Taxpayers to Save Proposition 13—on the ground that that group neither wished to participate in Commission proceedings nor alleged that its use of the billing envelope space would improve consumer participation in those proceedings. *Id.*, at A–157 to A–164. The record does not reveal whether any other groups have sought access to the billing envelopes.